

The Purpose and Value of a Professional Portfolio

Estimated time needed: 5 minutes

Objectives

After completing this reading, you will be able to:

- Explain the purpose of a professional portfolio
- List the potential portfolio contents
- Describe steps to build a professional portfolio

Purpose of a professional portfolio

A professional portfolio is a great way to share who you are, showcase the work you have accomplished, and demonstrate you have the skills to excel in a potential new role. A well-organized portfolio can set you apart from the rest. Here is a summary of professional portfolio attributes:

- Visually demonstrates competencies you would list on a resume or share in an interview
- Provides proof of your skills, accomplishments, and examples of your work
- Includes a compilation of some of your best work samples and professional documentation
- May be as simple as a binder or electronically compiled
- Allows you to SHOW and not simply TELL

Portfolio contents

Each portfolio should be unique and tailored to the role you are pursuing. There are general contents to consider. Here is a list of potential professional portfolio contents. Tailor the content to serve your needs.

- Headshot, brief biographical information, and contact information
- A professional statement, your career goals, your likes, and your passion
- Career summary (resume), educational experience, licenses, and certifications
- Information about past employers and your evaluations
- List of skills and photos of you at work
- Published articles, press releases, accolades, and testimonials
- References
- Notes to provide links to your best work

Steps to build a professional portfolio

Here is a list of steps to build a professional portfolio.

Step 1: Gather your materials: Choose examples that are recent, relevant, and significant.

Step 2: Organize the portfolio: Include a **table of contents** and headers.

Step 3: Create a visually appealing portfolio: Maintain consistency in formatting. Quantity does not necessarily equal quality.



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